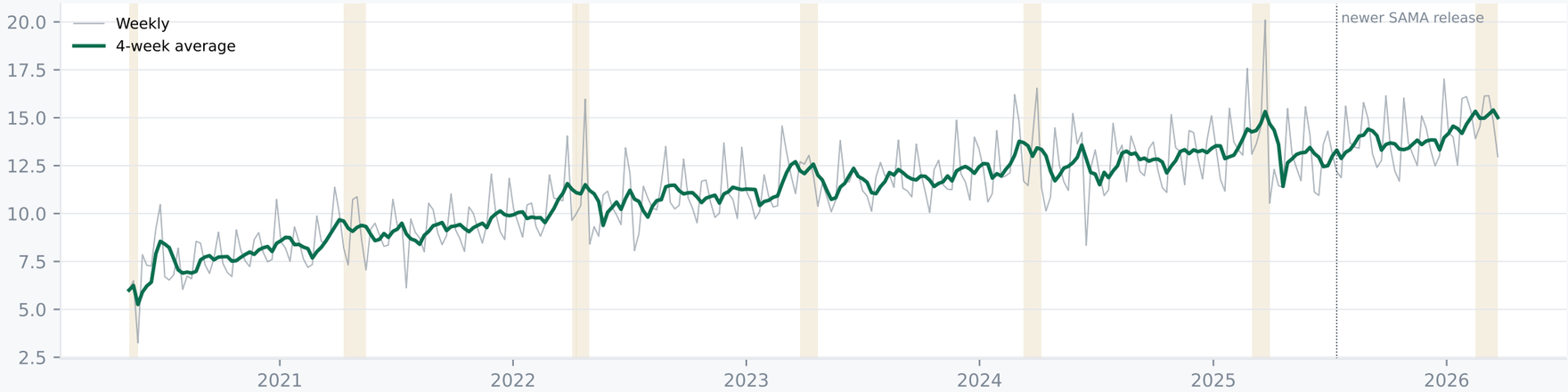
Saudi Consumer Spending Pulse

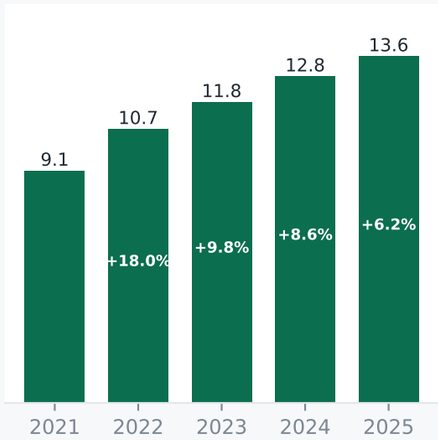
Weekly card point-of-sale spending in KSA, 2020-05-10 to 2026-03-22 (307 weeks)

POS spending 2025	Transactions 2025	Average ticket 2025	Riyadh share 2025	2026 to date (12 wks)
SAR 705 bn	**11.52 bn**	**SAR 61.2**	**34.6%**	**SAR 177 bn**
+6.2% YoY (avg weekly)	+11.6% YoY	-33.1% vs 2021	Jeddah 14.0%	+3.4% vs same weeks

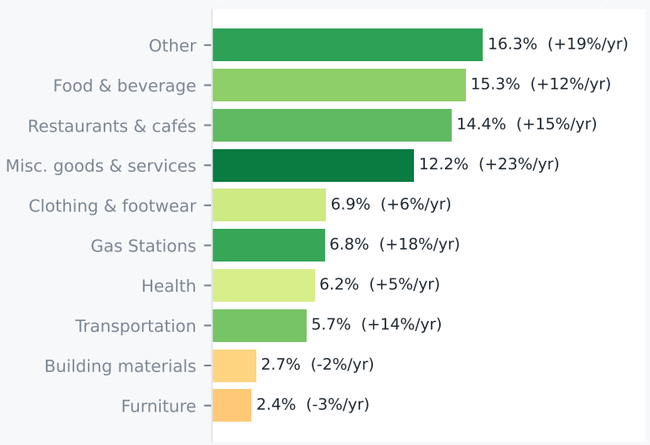
Weekly POS spending, SAR bn (gold bands = Ramadan weeks)



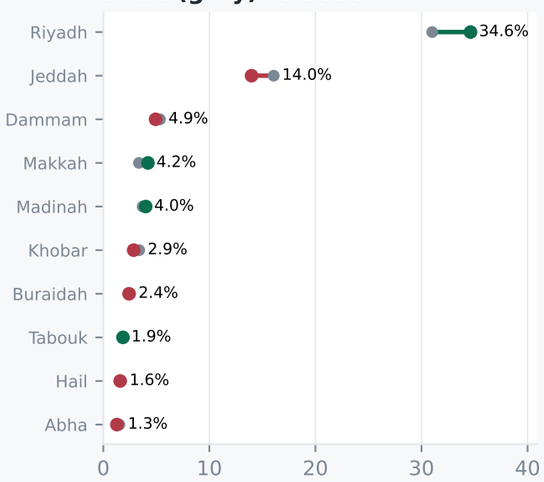
Avg weekly spend, SAR bn (label = YoY %)



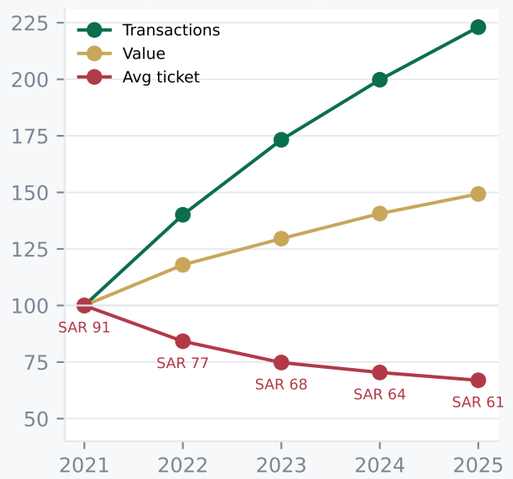
Top 10 sectors: share of 2024 value (colour/label = CAGR 2021-24)



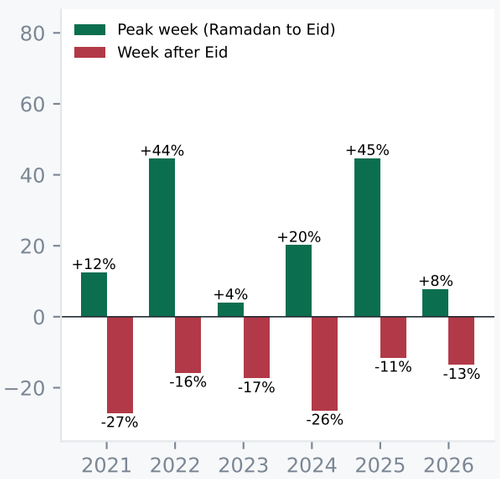
City share of national value 2021 (grey) to 2025



More, smaller payments (index, 2021 = 100)



Ramadan/Eid swing vs the 4 weeks before Ramadan



Source: Saudi Central Bank (SAMA) weekly POS statistics via KAPSARC Data Portal (datasets: point-of-sale-transactions-by-sector-and-city; detailed-point-of-sale-transactions-by-sector-and-city). Values are card POS transactions only; analysis by the author.

Executive summary

Saudi Consumer Spending Pulse | SAMA weekly POS data, 2020-05-10 to 2026-03-22

1. Spending keeps growing, but growth is slowing every year

Average weekly POS spending rose from SAR 9.08 bn in 2021 to SAR 13.57 bn in 2025 (+49.3%). Year-on-year growth has slowed each year, from +18.0% in 2022 to +6.2% in 2025. The first 12 weeks of 2026 were +3.4% on the same weeks a year earlier.

So what: Forecasts and budgets for consumer-facing businesses should assume mid-single-digit market growth, not the post-2020 rebound rates.

2. Cards are reaching smaller, everyday purchases

Weekly transaction counts grew +123.1% between 2021 and 2025, 2.5x the growth in value. The average ticket fell from SAR 91.4 to SAR 61.2 (-33.1%). The biggest named sectors are everyday ones: Beverage and Food (15.3% of 2024 value, SAR 41 average ticket) and Restaurants & Café (14.4%, SAR 33).

So what: This is consistent with the national cashless agenda. Merchants need low-friction card and wallet acceptance for low-value baskets.

3. Riyadh is gaining share; Jeddah is growing more slowly than the market

Riyadh's share of national POS value rose from 31.0% (2021) to 34.6% (2025). Jeddah remains the second-largest city at SAR 98.6 bn in 2025, but its share fell from 16.1% to 14.0%: Jeddah grew +29.9% against +66.7% for Riyadh and +49.3% nationally. Makkah (+87.0%) and Madinah (+60.9%) also grew faster than the national total.

So what: When planning store openings or regional marketing, weight Riyadh and the two holy cities more heavily. Jeddah's absolute size still makes it the main market in the west.

4. Ramadan and Eid bring a large, predictable spike and dip

Across 2021-2026, the peak week of the Ramadan-to-Eid window ran between 4% and 45% above the four weeks before Ramadan (median 16%). The week after Eid fell to between 11% and 27% below that baseline. The national peak week in the series (w/c 2025-03-23, SAR 20.1 bn) was the run-up to Eid al-Fitr. Clothing and Footwear and Jewelry both reach about 2.7x their pre-Ramadan level in their peak week (average over 5 years).

So what: Stock, staffing and campaigns should follow the Hijri calendar: the peak moves about 11 days earlier each Gregorian year.

5. Miscellaneous Goods and Services and Hotels grew fastest; Electronic & Electric Devices shrank

Between 2021 and 2024 (the last full year in the older sector taxonomy), Miscellaneous Goods and Services grew 23.0% a year, Hotels grew 19.4% a year (compound). Electronic & Electric Devices declined 8.6% a year. The top three sectors, including SAMA's catch-all 'Other', made up 46.1% of 2024 value.

So what: Hotel card spending growth is consistent with the tourism push. A shrinking POS line can also mean purchases moved online; these figures cover in-store terminals only.

Method: the raw SAMA CSVs are loaded into DuckDB, cleaned and pivoted in SQL, and modelled as a star schema (dim_date with Umm al-Qura Ramadan/Eid flags, dim_city, dim_sector, three weekly fact tables). Years are compared on average weekly values because some calendar years hold 53 week-starts. The newer SAMA release is appended only for national and city totals, which match the older release in the overlapping weeks; sector trends stop in July 2025 because the sector taxonomy changed. Figures cover card POS terminals only (no cash, no e-commerce).

Source: Saudi Central Bank (SAMA) weekly POS statistics via KAPSARC Data Portal (datasets: point-of-sale-transactions-by-sector-and-city; detailed-point-of-sale-transactions-by-sector-and-city). Values are card POS transactions only; analysis by the author.